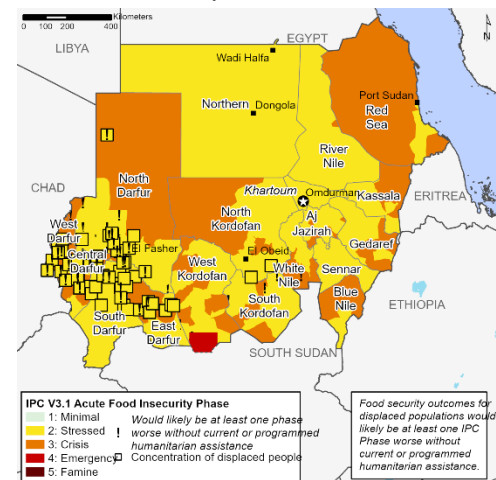


Conflict and poor macroeconomic conditions drive Crisis (IPC Phase 3) acute food insecurity

KEY MESSAGES

- In October 2022, above-average food prices, the persistent poor macroeconomic situation, and continuing inter-communal clashes are driving Stressed (IPC Phase 2) and Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes, with higher-than-normal humanitarian food assistance needs at the start of the harvest season. Humanitarian assistance needs are expected to remain higher than normal at least through May 2023, the beginning of the lean season. Areas of high concern include areas hosting IDPs and conflict-affected peoples in Darfur, Kordofan, and Blue Nile states, and areas of marginal agricultural production in the Red Sea, North Darfur, North Kordofan, and northern Kassala states.
- The June to September rainy season has continued into October, supporting crop development of late-planted crops, pasture regeneration, and improving water availability across the main agricultural and agropastoral livelihood zones of Sudan. The main season harvest is expected to start in November. The national harvest of staple food crops is likely to be higher than last year and near average. However, pest infestations, late planting, and replanting following flooding, along with increased inter-communal clashes, are expected to drive localized below-average harvests.

Current food security outcomes, October, 2022



Source: FEWS NET

FEWS NET's classifications are IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners.

- In October, staple food prices had mixed trends across different crops and main markets in Sudan. Prices in most markets began seasonally declining in anticipation of the upcoming harvest. However, staple food prices remained approximately 230 to 260 percent higher than prices in October 2021, and over seven times higher than the five-year average, driven by high production and transportation costs and the continued depreciation of the SDG.
- Sudan continues to experience a poor macroeconomic situation due to persistent low foreign currency reserves. In September, the government raised taxes on agricultural products, port and road fees, industry, and trade by 100 to 500 percent, resulting in strikes across the country, and the high taxes have disrupted import and export activities, further contributing to the high prices of imported food and non-food items. The high cost of living is being reflected in increasing production and marketing costs, and high food and non-food item prices, resulting in low households' purchasing power and an increasing number of households engaging in coping strategies to minimize food consumption gaps.
- Between July and October 2022, sporadic violent inter-communal clashes have continued, particularly in parts of West Kordofan, Blue Nile, and North Darfur states. In particular, at least 97,000 people have reportedly been displaced within Blue Nile and neighboring states since July following renewed inter-communal violence. An inter-agency mission was carried out across affected areas in Ar Rusayris locality and Ed Damazine town on October 27, while a mission to affected areas in Wad Al Mahi locality is planned for November 7, 2022. According to OCHA, about 34,000 people are taking shelter in schools in Ed Damazine town, but many IDPs are sleeping in the open due to overcrowding. Access to safe water is limited, and there is only one functioning hand pump forcing some people to use untreated water from the river Nile. Humanitarian partners continue extending life-saving assistance to affected people they can reach in Blue Nile and to IDPs in other localities and states. Assistance includes food, non-food items, health, water, and sanitation services.

NATIONAL OVERVIEW

Current Situation

Agricultural season performance: The June to September rainy season is concluding following above-average rainfall in August and September that has continued into October across most of Sudan. According to CHIRPS satellite-derived rainfall estimates, up to 200 percent of the 1981-2020 average rainfall for October has fallen in southeastern Sudan, particularly along the border of Sennar and Ethiopia. In October, the Normalized Difference Vegetation Index (NDVI) is showing above-average vegetation greenness, over 120 percent of the 2012-2021 mean, across the southern half of Sudan; however, there are localized areas across central Sudan where vegetation greenness is 80-95 percent of the 2012-2021 mean (Figure 1).

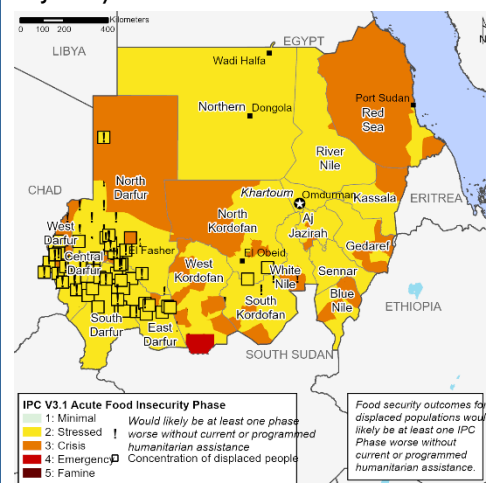
According to the findings of an inter-agency mid-season assessment conducted in mid-September 2022, the above-normal June to September 2022 rains continue to support favorable crop and pasture development in the agricultural and agropastoral zones of Sudan. Crop growth is varied between crop types and areas according to sowing dates. As of September, most cereal crops in the rain-fed semi-mechanized and irrigated sectors were in advanced vegetative growth stages. Sesame and groundnuts are at the flowering stage and the pod and fruit setting stage.

Upcoming harvest: In general, the agricultural season remains constrained by the impact of high prices and shortages of agricultural inputs, low access to finance, irrigation difficulties, flooding and waterlogging, and pest infestations. Although a harvest forecast likely will not be available until mid-January 2023, the current progress of the season indicates a better national harvest compared to last year and likely a near-average harvest, particularly for staple food crops. According to the mid-season assessment report, the total area planted by the end of August for the main summer crops (sorghum, millet, groundnuts, sesame, and cotton) is estimated at around 50.3 million feddans (~21.13 million hectares), around 77 percent of the 65.3 million feddans (23.3 million hectares) targeted for planting this year. In the semi-mechanized and irrigated sectors, an additional 2.2 million feddans are expected to be planted by the end of September, bringing the total planted area up to 52.5 million feddans (22 million hectares). This is around 80 percent of the targeted area for planting this season, similar to last year and 6 percent lower than the five-year average. Although the area planted is lower than last year, the harvest is expected to be near average following better rainfall distribution through the growing season and less impact from flooding compared to last year.

Staple crops: The area planted to sorghum and millet is similar to last year and the five-year average, estimated at 33.8 million feddans (14.2 million hectares), around 65 percent of the total area planted. Around 90 percent of the millet was planted in the traditional rain-fed sector, while 55 and 42 percent of the sorghum was planted in the semi-mechanized and the traditional rain-fed sub-sectors, respectively. In mid-September, crop conditions are better than last year in most of the rain-fed and irrigated sectors.

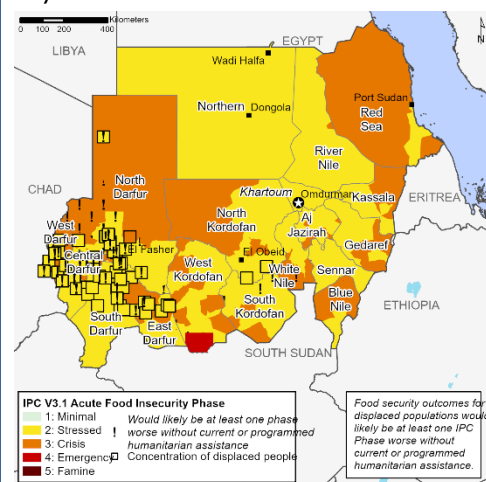
Cash crops: An estimated 36 percent of the total area planted was planted to cash crops, around 20.8 million feddan (8.7 million hectares). This is around 15 percent lower than last year and 10 percent lower than the five-year average. In particular, the area planted to groundnut was 36 percent and 20 percent lower compared to the last year and the five-year average. However, the area under sesame is around 5 percent higher than last year but 11 percent lower than the five-year average. The decline in the area planted sesame and groundnuts is driven by the high cost of production, and the impact of flooding

Projected food security outcomes, October 2022 to January 2023



Source: FEWS NET

Projected food security outcomes, February to May 2023



Source: FEWS NET

FEWS NET's classifications are IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners.

and waterlogging during August and September. To recover their harvests, more farmers switched to early maturing sorghum when replanting areas affected by flooding. However, the area planted to cotton, around 1.3 million feddans, is 5.5 percent higher compared to the area planted last year and 197 percent higher than the five-year average. The increase in area planted to cotton was driven by the availability of finance for contracting farmers, and the relatively better prices. Current preset cotton prices are around 50 SDG/guntar (45 kg), compared to 27-35 SDG/guntar last year.

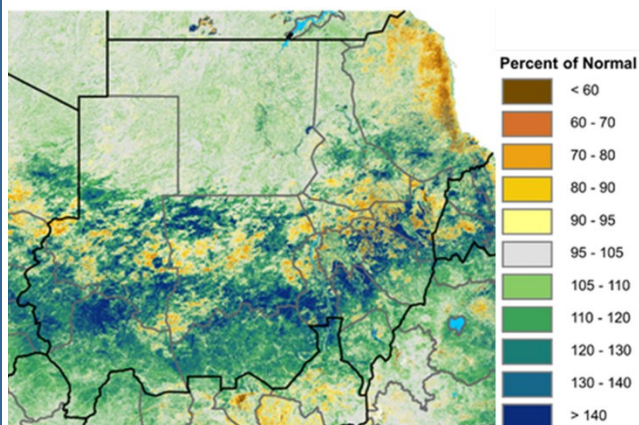
Market and trade: In October, staple food prices had mixed trends across most of the main markets in Sudan, as market prices adjust from the end of the lean season in September and the typical start of the harvest in October.

In early October, **sorghum and millet** retail prices were primarily stable across the main markets in Sudan. Millet prices are beginning to seasonally decline in Al Gadaref, Ad Deain, El Fasher, Senga Alnuhood, and Khartoum markets due to the availability of early-maturing crops from the ongoing season, while remaining relatively stable in other markets. However, sorghum prices increased 5-10 percent in most markets, but remained stable or declined 5-10 percent in a few monitored markets due to continued high demand and seasonally reduced market supplies. On average, sorghum is selling for approximately 453 SDG/kg in October, a 9 percent increase compared to September 2022. Sorghum prices in October are around 230 percent higher than prices last year and over seven times higher than the five-year average. On average, retail millet prices are 763 SDG/kg in October, a 2 percent decrease compared to September, but remained 260 percent higher than prices in October 2021 and eight times higher than the five-year average. The high national average price of retail sorghum and millet prices continues to be driven by the high transportation and marketing costs, the continued devaluation of the SDG, and continued high demand as the lean season comes to an end (Figure 2).

Locally produced wheat retail prices unseasonably decreased across most markets between September and October 2022, likely driven by excess market supply originating from carried-over farmer's stocks following the government's reluctance to purchase around 0.6 million tons of locally produced wheat from the 2021/22 winter season (Figure 2). Wheat is trading at a national average of 553 SDG/kg in October, 5 percent lower than September, but it remains on average almost double compared to prices in October 2021, and over 400 to 500 percent above the five-year average. However, bread prices remain stable at around 40-50 SDG per loaf.

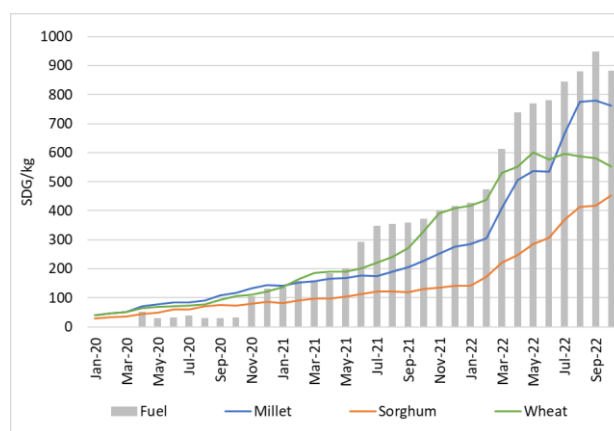
Livestock prices: Across Sudan livestock prices tended to decline due to low demand for local consumption because of high prices and reduced household purchasing power, along with increased market supply from pastoral and agropastoral groups as they seek to earn income for food purchases. Between September and October, livestock prices had mixed price trends across most markets. Goat prices unseasonably decreased 5-10 percent in Ad Damazin, Al Gadaref, Kadugli, Rabak, and Dongola markets while either remaining stable or slightly increasing in other markets. In particular, sheep prices declined 10-20 percent across most markets between September and October 2022, while remaining relatively stable or slightly decreasing in a few markets. This is mainly due to the reduced demand for local consumption along with lower-than-typical export activities due to the high increase in custom taxes and port fees. Overall, goat and sheep prices in October remain 50-100 percent above prices last year and 300-400 percent above the five-year average, driven by the continued high inflation and the local currency depreciation.

Figure 1. Normalized Difference Vegetation Index (NDVI), percent of the 2012-2021 mean, October 16-25, 2022



Source: FEWS NET

Figure 2. The national average price of sorghum, wheat, millet, and fuel, January 2020 to October 2022



Source: FEWS NET

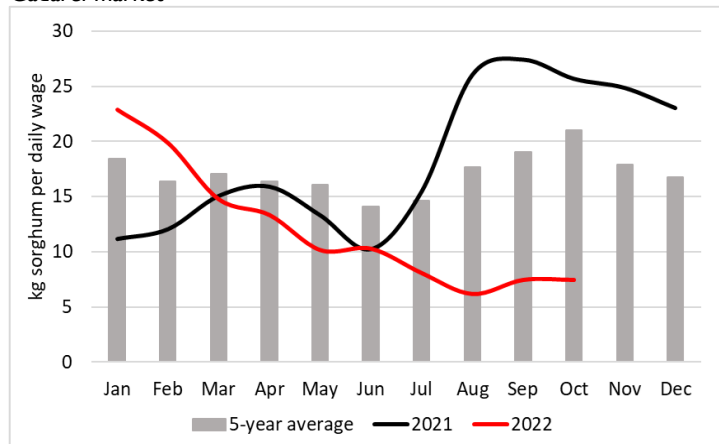
Terms-of-trade (TOT): The goat-to-sorghum and labor-to-sorghum terms-of-trade, proxies for household purchasing power, slightly improved across most markets in October as sorghum prices either remained stable or slightly decreased. In the El Obied market, the goat-to-sorghum terms-of-trade increased 6 percent between September and October, with the sale of a goat purchasing around 94 kg of sorghum in October, compared to 88.6 kg of sorghum per goat in September 2022. In El Obied, the improvement in the terms of trade in October is mainly driven by a slight increase in goat prices, while sorghum prices remained unchanged. Overall, the October 2022 goat-to-sorghum terms-of-trade across Sudan are 60-70 percent lower than respective prices in 2021 and 50-60 percent below the five-year average. In Al Gadaref market, the labor-to-sorghum terms-of-trade increased to 7.4 kg of sorghum per daily wage in September and October, compared to 6.2 kg of sorghum per daily wage in August 2022, driven by the 20 percent increase in labor wages following increased demand for labor with the start of the harvest (Figure 3). Across Sudan, the labor-to-sorghum terms-of-trade in October remained approximately 70 percent lower than last year and 65 percent lower than the five-year average. Despite the improvement in goat-to-sorghum and labor-to-sorghum terms-of-trade, and the expected improvement in access to sorghum, the cumulative high cost of food and non-food needs are continuing to constrain household purchasing power and limit households access to adequate food, with many households coping by purchasing lower quality and cheaper food.

Macroeconomic difficulties: The poor economic situation continues due to persistent low foreign currency reserves, the depreciation of the SDG, high inflation rates, longstanding insecurity, and political instability. In October, commercial banks and the parallel market are trading on average at around 576-579 SDG/USD compared to 439-448 SDG/USD in October 2021.

In September, the government raised taxes on agricultural products, port and road fees, industry, and trade by 100 to 500 percent, resulting in strikes across the country. The high taxes have disrupted import and export activities and contributed to the high prices of imported food and non-food items. These decisions will directly be reflected in increasing the already high production and marketing costs and continue to constrain household purchasing power.

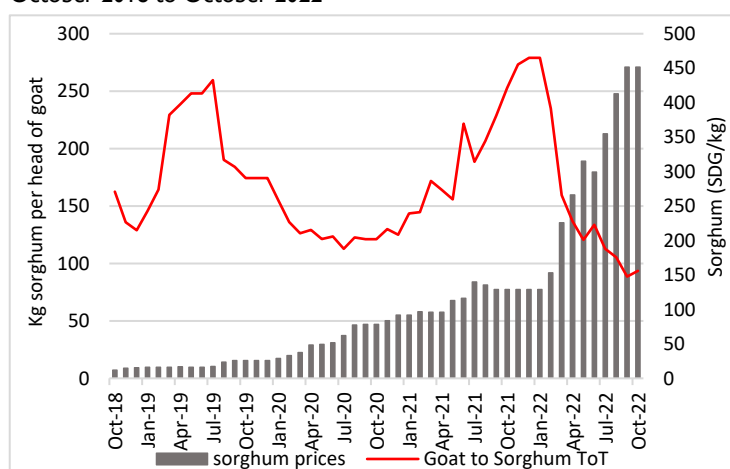
In September, the Consumer Price Index (CPI) increased to 65,138 points, a 10.7 percent increase from August 2022, and 107 percent higher compared to September 2021, indicating that food and non-cereal food items prices are continuing to rise (Figure 4). Although the annual inflation rate has continued to decline, it is still in triple digits, reflecting the high price of goods and cost of living. Relatedly, in September 2022, the average cost of the [WFP local food basket](#) increased to 566 SDG (~0.98 USD), an 8 percent increase from August 2022 and 143 percent higher than in September 2021.

Figure 3. Labor-to-sorghum terms-of-trade (ToT) (kg/daily wage), Al Gadaref market



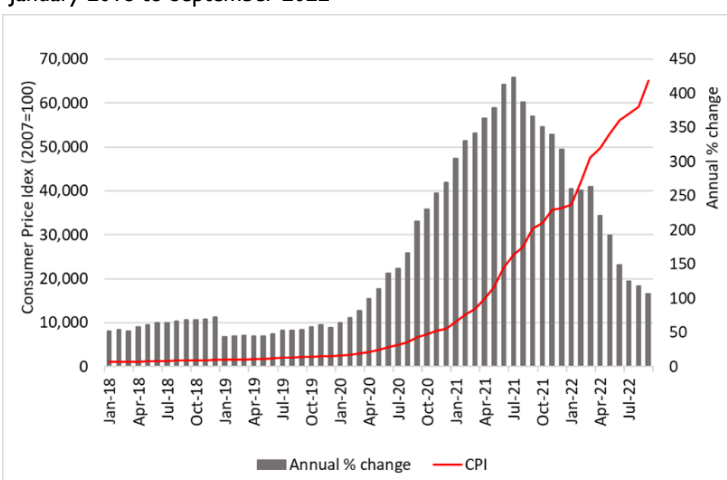
Source: FEWS NET

Figure 4. Goat-to-sorghum terms-of-trade (kg/goat), El Obied market, October 2018 to October 2022



Source: FEWS NET

Figure 5. Consumer Price Index (2007=100) and annual percent change, January 2018 to September 2022



Source: FEWS NET

Conflict and peace process: Between July and October 2022, sporadic violent inter-communal clashes have continued in Sudan particularly in West Kordofan, Blue Nile, and North Darfur states. The most recent violent clashes occurred in Lagawa, West Kordofan state and in Wad Al Mahi, Blue Nile state. In Lagawa, tensions escalated on October 10 following a land ownership dispute, at least 36,500 people reportedly fleeing Lagawa town. In Blue Nile state, inter-communal violence that spread into Blue Nile's Ar Rusyaris locality from Wad Al Mahi, renewed on October 13 in Dam town 6 (Village 6 and 7), with unconfirmed reports estimating that 1,200 people have been displaced and are taking refuge in schools and the nearby refugee camp. In early October, tensions between security forces and community leaders in Sortony IDP camp escalated in and around the wider Sortony Area in Kebkabiya locality, North Darfur, where an estimated 5,000 individuals fled from Sortony IDP camp to Kebkabiya. The conflict and insecurity across Sudan are continuing to disrupt the agricultural season, particularly reducing household access to income from agricultural labor, loss of household's assets, and reduced households' access to food from either the upcoming harvest or markets, resulting in an increased need for humanitarian assistance.

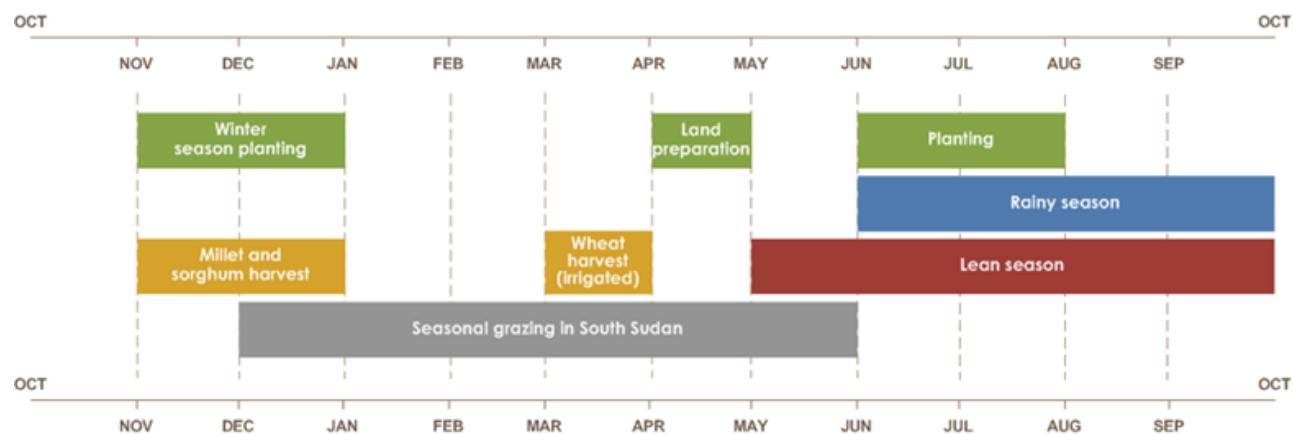
Humanitarian assistance:

In October 2022, WFP and implementing partners provided approximately 1.6 million beneficiaries with 50 percent rations of in-kind food assistance (~16,109 metric tons) and around 861,000 USD in cash transfers. Most beneficiaries included IDPs and conflict-affected people in Greater Darfur, Greater Kordofan, the Blue Nile states, refugees from South Sudan, Eritrea, and Ethiopia, people affected by inter-communal clashes and floods, and the severely food-insecure residents. WFP plans to distribute over 123,550 metric tons and over 67.4 million USD in cash transfers to 5 million beneficiaries between November 2022 and April 2023.

Current Food Security Outcomes

In October 2022, household food security is beginning to improve seasonally, driven by increasing access to the harvest of earlier maturing crops from the ongoing 2022/2023 main agricultural season, and improved access to in-kind and cash payments from agricultural labor. Additionally, stable or declining cereal prices and the improvement in goat-to-sorghum and labor-to-sorghum terms-of-trades is improving access to market purchases, but the significantly above-average prices of essential food and non-food items are continuing to limit household purchasing power. Despite the relative improvement in access to food and income, the poor macroeconomic situation and consistently high prices of food and non-food items are driving worse than typical food security outcomes at the start of the harvest period. Moreover, the recent inter-communal clashes and increased displacement in areas of the Blue Nile, West Kordofan, and parts of Darfur states and the continued social tensions and political instability in different parts of the country are likely resulting in localized disruptions to the start of the harvest, limiting household access to own production, income from agricultural labor opportunities and crop sales in many areas. Overall, many areas in the country are expected to face Stressed (IPC Phase 2) food security outcomes, with Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes in areas recently affected by intercommunal clashes and displacements such as Blue Nile, West Kordofan, and parts of Darfur. Additionally, Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are most likely in areas of Darfur, Kordofan, and Blue Nile states with a high number of protracted IDPs and conflict-affected peoples, and areas of marginal production in the Red Sea, North Darfur, North Kordofan, Northern Kassala.

SEASONAL CALENDAR FOR A TYPICAL YEAR



Source: FEWS NET

Assumptions

The most likely scenario for October 2022 to May 2023 is based on the following national-level assumptions:

- The national 2022/2023 harvest, particularly for staple food crops, is likely to be near average following average to above-average rainfall, despite delays in planting in some areas, lower access to irrigation, finance, and agricultural inputs, and the negative impacts of flooding and water logging in August and September and pest infestation.
- Sudan's macroeconomic situation is likely to continue to deteriorate through the scenario period due to the international community's suspension of major economic support following the overthrow of the civilian-led transitional government in October 2021, persistent low foreign currency reserves, the depreciation of the SDG, high inflation rates, longstanding insecurity, and political instability.
- The area expected to be planted to wheat for the upcoming 2022/23 winter season is expected to be lower than last year and the five-year average. Below-average planting is expected due to shortages and the high cost of agricultural inputs, limited access to agricultural finance, and the high uncertainty about the government's commitment to purchase the produced wheat from the farmers.
- In October 2022, the SDG exchange rate in the parallel market is trading at around 578, with commercial banks trading at around 577 SDG/USD. The parallel market exchange rate will likely remain high throughout the scenario period due to the persistent lack of a sustainable hard currency stream and the high need for imports. This will likely result in reduced imports, particularly food, and further price increases. Based on FEWS NET's integrated FOREX projections, the SDG is expected to be 550-600SDG/USD through May 2023.
- Sorghum and millet prices are anticipated to seasonally decrease from October 2022 through March 2023 relative to the June-September lean season following the harvest. Based on FEWS NET's integrated price projections, sorghum and millet prices are expected to be over 150-200 percent higher than their respective prices last year and four to five times above the five-year average across most markets in Sudan during the projection period.
- Locally produced wheat prices are likely to remain relatively stable between October and February and seasonally decrease between March and May 2023, with the beginning of the winter wheat harvest in March. Prices are likely to remain more than double compared to respective prices in 2022 and over 400 percent above the five-year average through May 2023.
- Livestock prices are expected to follow seasonal trends but at relatively high prices compared to the average due to high inflation and local currency depreciation. Livestock prices are expected to remain relatively stable or slightly decrease from October 2022 to February 2023 in most markets as households from pastoral and agro-pastoral groups sell more livestock for income to purchase food. Livestock prices are likely to start seasonally decreasing between March and May 2023 as the lean season approaches. Overall, livestock prices are expected to remain almost double compared to last year and over 400 percent above the five-year average through May 2023.
- The livestock-to-cereal terms-of-trade (TOT), a proxy for pastoral household purchasing power, is expected to improve in November- the start of the harvest season- and continue improving through March 2023. However, from March to May 2023, the TOT will likely begin seasonally declining, driven by the anticipated high sorghum prices while livestock prices are expected to begin seasonally decrease. The TOT is likely to remain 50-60 percent lower than the respective TOT in 2021/22, and 40-50 percent below the five-year average due to the above-average sorghum prices.
- Agricultural labor opportunities and wages are expected to increase seasonally during the harvest period between November 2022 and January 2023, ranging from 4000 to 6000 SDG/day. Labor opportunities and wages will start to seasonally decrease with the end of the harvest period in February 2023 but remain around 3000-4000 SDG/day through May 2023. Labor wages are anticipated to be 80-100 percent above last year and 200-300 percent above the five-year average.
- Pastoral and daily wage-dependent households are expected to have limited purchasing power throughout the scenario period due to the rising cost of food and non-food needs, limited access to income due to reduced economic activity, and increased competition for income-earning opportunities. Poor households are likely to engage in different coping strategies to meet their household's essential needs such as selling non-productive animals more than usual, borrowing, and begging to earn income and minimize food consumption gaps.

- WFP and implementing partners are expected to distribute over 123,550 metric tons and over 67.4 USD million in cash transfers to 5 million beneficiaries between November 2022 and April 2023. Most of the targeted beneficiaries are IDPs and conflict-affected people in Greater Darfur, government-controlled areas of South Kordofan and the Blue Nile, refugees from South Sudan, and chronically food-insecure areas of eastern and western Sudan, Ethiopian refugees from the Tigray region, and South Sudanese refugees fleeing conflict.
- The frequency and magnitude of civil unrest is likely to remain at current levels in Khartoum and other major urban centers through May 2023. The security forces will continue to use forceful measures to disperse protesters, resulting in sporadic civilian fatalities at major demonstrations. Casualty counts will likely increase as the government continues to withhold meaningful political concessions, and both security forces and demonstrators become quicker to escalate to violence during significant protests.
- While incidents of violence against civilians in Darfur peaked, as is typical, during the height of the rainy season in July 2022, surpassing levels observed during the same time in 2021 and 2020, the number of civilians killed during these events was fewer than those during the same period 2021, and less than half of the death toll from the same period in 2020. In Kordofan, attacks on civilians remained concentrated in South Kordofan, occurring at nearly half the levels in May-July 2022 compared to the same period in 2021; however, a surge in violence and associated fatalities in West Kordofan occurred in June that surpassed any on record in recent years. The frequency of communal riots has likely increased due to a security vacuum since the U.N.'s withdrawal from Darfur in June 2021.
- Intercommunal violence in Darfur and Kordofan states will continue to increase outside of cyclical rainy seasons as a result of the continued dispute over lands and natural resources, and retaliatory cycles of violence. Violence will likely escalate as is historically typical during the harvest season between November 2022 and January 2023. Violence in the lead-up to, and during the harvest season is likely to be at higher levels compared to 2021-2022 due to increasing disputes over access to farming lands and competition for scarce natural resources between pastoralists and farmers, as well as an additional twelve months of economic stagnation, and nearly 18 months since the departure of the UN peacekeeping force. Thereafter, violence is likely to ebb until April, when violence will likely begin to increase towards the end of the seasonal grazing period and the start of the lean season. Government efforts to reduce violence are likely to be stymied due to the presence of multiple armed groups in Darfur's main urban centers, including several of which are signatories of the Juba Peace Agreement (JPA). The lack of progress in the implementation of the agreement will likely spur further incidents of sporadic violence.

Most Likely Food Security Outcomes

From October 2022 to January 2023, acute food insecurity outcomes for most households will improve relative to the lean season as food access improves with the start of the expected near average harvest. In particular, poor households will improve their food access from own production, in-kind payments from agricultural labor, and in-kind *Zakat* of the crop from better-off households. Additionally, poor households in the agriculture and agropastoral areas are likely to increase their access to cash income from agricultural labor during the harvest period. Labor-to-sorghum and goat-to-sorghum terms-of-trade are likely to improve as cereal prices are likely to seasonally decline during the harvest but remain significantly above average due to the high production and transportation costs this year. As a result, many areas in Sudan are expected to face Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes supported by increased access to food and slightly lower food prices. However, in the conflict-affected areas in the Blue Nile, Kordofan, and Darfur states, conflict-affected and displaced people will continue to have limited access to their household harvest and labor opportunities. In these areas, poor households are likely to continue facing food consumption deficits and income below their livelihood protection thresholds, remaining in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) through January 2023.

February to May is typically the post-harvest period and the beginning of the lean season in Sudan. During the post-harvest period of February to April 2023, acute food security outcomes for most people will likely remain relatively stable supported by the anticipated near-average national harvest and relative stability of cereal prices. Following the end of the harvest in February, poor households' access to in-kind payments and cash income from agricultural labor, and animal and crop sales will typically decline and reach seasonal lows during the June to September 2023 lean season, along with increases in staple food prices, as food stocks decline, and households increase their dependence on market purchases for food. To earn income, households' members will likely migrate in search of labor, rely on remittances, increase their reliance on income from petty trade, and increase their engagement in coping strategies. The anticipated increase in already well-above-average prices of

food and non-food items, along with low household purchasing power will continue to drive higher needs between February and May 2023. As a result, of the increase in food prices and low purchasing power, many poor households across Sudan will likely remain Stressed (IPC Phase 2). However, an increased number of IDPs, conflict-affected people, and poor households in the Blue Nile, parts of Kordofan, Darfur, and the northern parts of North Darfur, northern Kassala, and much of Red Sea states are likely to face Crisis (IPC Phase 3) food security outcomes.

Events that Might Change the Outlook

Table 1. Possible events over the next eight months that could change the most-likely scenario.

Area	Event	Impact on food security outcomes
National	Disputing national level political groups successfully reach an agreement to return to a civilian-led government	This will likely reduce political tensions and inter-communal clashes, allow the Sudanese economy to reintegrate with the global market, and improve the macroeconomic conditions in Sudan. A reduction in food and non-food prices will improve household purchasing power and improving area-level food security in many affected areas from Crisis (IPC Phase3) to Stressed (IPC Phase 2).
Dordieb, Agig, Haya, and Jubayt Elma'aadin localities in Red Sea State	Evenly distributed good rainfall through the October to December short winter rainy season	This will likely result in an above-average harvest from flood retreat cultivation and the upcoming winter season, improving livestock body conditions, agricultural production, and household income. This will reduce the food consumption deficits from January to May 2023, and the number of households facing Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse outcomes.
Ar Rusayris and Wad Almahi localities, Blue Nile state	Further escalation of the inter-communal clashes and social tension	Increased intercommunal clashes and civil unrest will further disrupt the harvest, reduce labor opportunities, and disrupt access to markets. Additionally, clashes are likely to result in further displacement and a deterioration in household food insecurity.

AREAS OF CONCERN

Dordieb, Jubayt Elma'aadin, Agig, and Haya localities of the Red Sea state, Khors Agropastoral zone) (SD 5) (Figure 6)

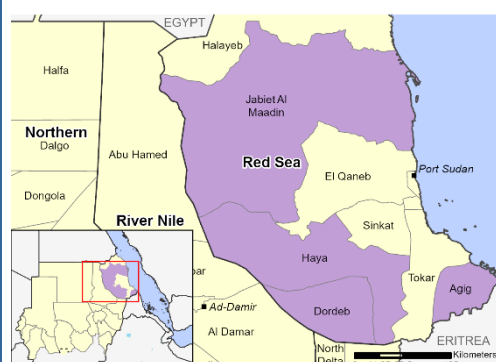
The area of concern is primarily located within the [Eastern Khors Agropastoral livelihood zone](#) in Red Sea state and comprises of a substantial series of *khors* (seasonal small streams in valleys). It is an agropastoral livelihood zone where crops are grown entirely for home consumption, and livestock, primarily goats, provide milk and, more importantly, cash for cereal purchases and other essentials. The area is well known for its high poverty rates, with poor households representing more than 50 percent of the population in the livelihood zone.

Current Situation

Following the below-average national harvest in the 2021/2022 agricultural season, the area of concern has reportedly had limited supply of food to markets, which has been exacerbated by the high cost of transportation. Additionally, poor households are typically market dependent from May to November and the high cost of goods has resulted in well below-average purchasing power, limiting household access to food.

2022/23 Agricultural Season: According to the Red Sea state's Food Security Technical Secretariat (SFSTS) bulletin for July to September 2022, planting in the Delta Tokar flood irrigated scheme-the main summer season cultivation area in Red Sea

Figure 6. Area of concern reference map, Dordieb, Agig, Haya, and Jubayt Elma'aadin localities in Red Sea State.



Source: FEWS NET

state started in the last week of September, around a month later than normal, due to flooding and waterlogging. Overall, less than 50 percent of the area typically cultivated was planted as a result of the delay, shortages and high price of inputs, and high labor costs. The government estimates that in addition to the individual household plots of land around the main *Khors* (seasonal valleys), just over 30,700 feddans were planted this season out of the around 65,000 feddans of cultivable flood-irrigated land in the Toker flood-irrigated scheme. Most of the cultivated crops are at the vegetative growth stages and are in good condition, with the harvest of the flood irrigated sorghum likely to occur around February 2023.

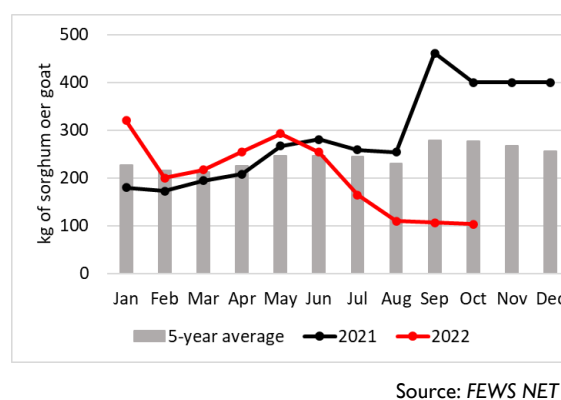
The well-above-average rainfall did support water and pasture conditions, particularly in the southern localities. Supported by improvements in pasture conditions and water access, livestock body conditions are generally good. However, shortages and high vaccine and medicine prices remain the main challenges facing the livestock sector. As a result of the improvements in livestock body conditions from July to September 2022, herders are reducing market supply as they seek to improve herd sizes. As a result of the reduced supply of livestock, prices in Port Sudan market slightly increased in August and September.

Staple Food prices in monitored markets in Red Sea either continued to seasonably increase or remained stable, but at high prices, between August and October 2022. In Port Sudan's main market, prices of sorghum Mogod (the preferred sorghum variety) remained at 1000-1066 SDG/kg between August and October, but prices are 150-160 percent higher than last year and more than 10 times above the five-year average. In the Kassala market, the second main market adjacent to the area of concern, sorghum is retailing at 410 SDG/kg in October, approximately 207 percent above prices last year, and 770 percent above the five-year average. The above-average staple food prices are attributed to the high production, transportation, and marketing costs, in addition to the poor macroeconomic situation and depreciation of the SDG. However, sorghum prices are expected to begin decreasing in November as the new summer season harvest reaches the markets.

Livestock prices: In Port Sudan's main market, livestock prices remained unchanged between June and October 2022, with goat and sheep prices stabilizing on average at 110,000 to 115,000 SDG per head since June 2022, which is 40-50 percent above October 2021 prices and almost four times above the five-year average. Although the livestock prices are well above prices last year and the five-year average, and are supporting households as a source of income, it is important to note that the prices of food and other goods have increased at faster rates.

Terms-of-trade: Between June and October 2022, the goat-to-sorghum terms-of-trade dropped by 59 percent, with a goat selling for 103 kg of sorghum in October, sufficient to meet up to 29 days of kilocalorie requirements for a household of six if they only consumed sorghum. However, the goat-to-sorghum terms-of-trade has significantly fallen since May 2022, when households could purchase 293 kg of sorghum per goat sold (Figure 13). The decline in the goat-to-sorghum terms-of-trade is being driven by a nearly 140 percent increase in sorghum prices from June to October. The increase in sorghum prices is being driven by seasonally reduced market supplies and increased demand for local consumption. The current terms-of-trade is almost 75 percent lower than last year and about 65 percent lower than the five-year average. The low TOT is continuing to weaken households purchasing power. Additionally, the goat-to-sorghum terms-of-trade in October is the lowest terms-of-trade FEWS NET has recorded since January 2014, when FEWS NET began to regularly track market prices at the Port Sudan.

Figure 7. Goat-to-sorghum terms-of-trade (kg/goat), Port Sudan market.



The poor rural households, particularly in the remote areas of concern in the Red Sea State, continue to face below-average access to their normal sources of food and income due to limited own production, persistently high rates of poverty, lower than normal access to income, poor purchasing power, and high prices resulting from the high cost of transportation, reduced market supplies, and other macroeconomic factors. To earn income for market purchases many households are engaging in firewood collection or charcoal production, agricultural and non-agricultural labor, and limited livestock sales; however, increased competition and limited opportunities are resulting in below-normal income. Many households are increasingly engaging in coping strategies indicative of Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse to minimize food consumption gaps or earn more income such as spending savings, reducing the quantity and quality of meals, selling more livestock than usual, selling their last female animal, withdrawing children from schools, and begging due to destitution.

Assumptions

In addition to the national-level assumptions, the following assumptions apply to this area of concern:

- Cereal prices are anticipated to remain significantly above average throughout the scenario period, with the price of the flood-irrigated sorghum expected to remain at above-average prices through the next harvest in February 2023. Prices are likely to remain more than 200 percent above respective prices the year before and more than six times higher than the five-year average. Additionally, the poor macroeconomic conditions are expected result in prices increasing before the start of the lean season in April and May 2022.
- Access to non-agricultural job opportunities in the main urban centers are likely to remain below average due to the continued strikes and instability in the main ports and trade activities. Wages are also likely to be negatively impacted by reduced opportunities and high labor supply by migrants, while the high cost of living in areas of migration is expected to result in below-normal remittances.
- Poor macroeconomic conditions, high food and non-food prices, and below-normal income will continue limiting poor household purchasing power throughout the scenario period. Household purchasing power and food access is expected to be exacerbated by the anticipated earlier than-usual increase in food prices before the typical start of the lean season in April and May 2023.

Most Likely Food Security Outcomes

From October 2022 to January 2023, poor household access to sorghum from market purchases will improve slightly with the relative stability of prices as the staple food reach the markets across Sudan. However, access to the market purchases will continue to be below normal due to significantly above-average prices that will limit household purchasing power. Additionally, poor households will remain fully market dependent until the start of the harvest of flood-retreat crops in February. However, households will likely have limited access to income from agricultural labor opportunities leading up to the harvest. Overall, the anticipated high prices of food and non-cereal food items are expected to continue reducing poor households' access to food, resulting in moderate food consumption gaps and increased reliance on cereals for food through January 2023, driving Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes.

From February to May 2023, poor households are expected to access food from the below-average flood retreat harvest. This is likely to improve household food access for a shorter than normal period of time, along with payments from agricultural labor, and in-kind *Zakat*. However, income from agricultural labor will likely be below-average due to the anticipated below-average harvest. As a result, households are expected to remain heavily dependent on market purchases, with the high market prices limiting household purchasing power. To earn income, poor households will likely continue relying on self-employment activities such as firewood and charcoal sales, limited livestock sales, and migrating to urban areas for casual labor opportunities particularly in Port Sudan and Sawaken town or migrating to areas for gold mining opportunities. However, poor households are likely to continue engaging in coping strategies indicative of Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse to minimize food consumption gaps due to the high cost of food and limited access to income.

Ar Rusayris and Wad Almahi localities, Blue Nile state, Southeast Rainfed Semi-Mechanized Agriculture livelihood zone (zone SD-10) (Figure 8)

The areas of concern are the Ar Rusayries and Wad Al Mahi localities in Blue Nile state where most households are rain-fed farmers who cultivate plots of four to six hectares. Farmers also engage in small-scale pump-irrigated, rainfed, and riverine vegetable production year-round for food and cash income. The irrigated farming takes place along the east bank of the Blue Nile and in areas flooded by the Ar Rusayries Dam Lake.

Current Situation

Since July 2022 Ar Rusayries and Wad Al Mahi localities have been affected by continued violent inter-communal clashes between members of the Hausa Tribe and the Hamaj and Barta tribes. More recently, inter-communal violence erupted on October 24, spreading through several villages in Ar Rusayries and Wad Almahi localities. According to the IOM

Figure 8. Area of concern reference map, Ar Rusayris and Wad Al Mahi localities in Blue State.



Source: FEWS NET

Displacement Tracking Matrix (DTM), over 97,000 people were displaced across Blue Nile state, with many others affected. The conflict has resulted in widespread burning of villages and looting of household assets including livestock. Additionally, the conflict is disrupting access to typical income-earning opportunities such as agricultural labor, fishing, and trade, along with access to markets and farms. In particular, households in Ar Rusayries and Wad Al Mahi localities have limited access to their farms and are unable to participate in the start of the harvest.

2022/23 agricultural season. According to the findings of an inter-agency mid-season assessment conducted from September 5 to 24, 2022, the total area planted in Blue Nile state is estimated at around 3 million feddans (1.3 million hectares), around 5 percent lower than last year, and close to the five-year average of 3.2 million feddans. An estimated 57 percent of the total planted area is sorghum and millet (1.7 million feddans), almost 9 percent lower than last year and similar to the five-year average. However, farmers did increase the area planted to sorghum compared to what was initially targeted for planting, incentivised by high prices last year, along with replanting flood affected areas with early-maturing sorghum varieties. The area cultivated by main cash crops is estimated at 1.3 million feddans, around 43 percent of the total planted area, around 9 percent higher than last year and over 20 percent higher than the five-year average. The rise in area planted to cash crops, particularly cotton, is being driven by access to contracts to grow cotton from private companies. According to field reports, most sorghum in the rain-fed sector is entering the advanced vegetative growth stage and grain-filling stage, while sesame, ground nut, sunflower and most of the cotton are in the reproductive and maturing crop growth stages.

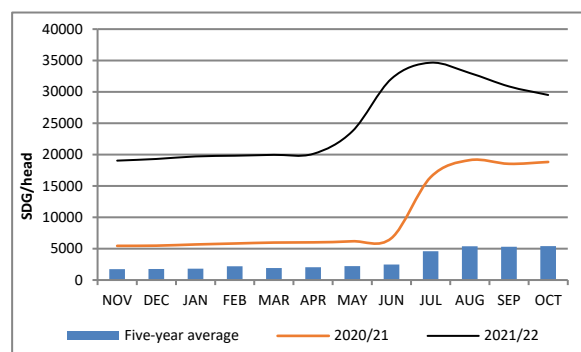
Staple Food prices in Ad Damazin main market recorded significant unseasonal increases in October 2022, following the disruptions to markets and supply flows from the inter-communal clashes. In October 2022, sorghum is retailing at 500 SDG/kg compared to 389 SDG/kg in September, a nearly 30 percent increase, and prices are around 465 percent higher than October 2021. The significantly above-average cereal prices are attributed to reduced market supplies due to the conflict, which is also disrupting the start of the harvest, along with increased market demand for local consumption. The current high staple food prices are coupled with the reduced access to income as the prevailing insecurity continues to limit household purchasing power.

Livestock prices in the Ad Damazin market continued to decrease unseasonably between July and October 2022, driven by increased supply from agropastoral households to earn income for cereal purchases, but there is generally low demand for livestock due to the conflict and market disruptions. Goat prices have fallen around 17 percent between July and October, but remain 57 percent higher compared to October 2021 and 476 percent above the five-year average (Figure 9).

Agricultural labor opportunities and wages have also been negatively impacted by the recent intercommunal clashes in the area. Labor wages dropped by 13 percent between August and October 2022 and remain 30 percent lower than respective wages last year. However, due to the high tension in the area, displaced and affected households are not able to access farms to earn income from agricultural labor.

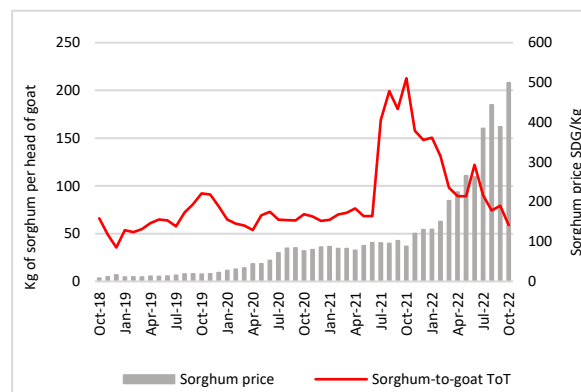
Terms-of-trade. Goat-to-sorghum and labor-to-sorghum terms-of-trade continued to drop unseasonably between June and October 2022, driven by the increase in sorghum prices, while both goat prices and labor wages declined. In Ad Damazin market, the goat-to-sorghum TOT dropped by 21 percent between September and October 2022, with one goat able to purchase around 59 kg of sorghum in October, sufficient to meet up to 20 days of monthly kilocalorie needs for a household of six if all they consume is sorghum. In comparison, the goat-to-sorghum in June 2022 could purchase 90 kg of sorghum per goat. Overall, the terms-of-trade in October 2022 remained 72 percent lower than last year and 47 percent lower than the

Figure 9. Goat prices in Ad-Damazin market, Blue Nile state



Source: FEWS NET

Figure 10. Goat-to-sorghum terms-of-trade kg/goat, Ad Damazin market, Blue Nile state, October 2018 to October 2022.



Source: FEWS NET

five-year average. The low TOT is expected to continue weakening households' purchasing ability, particularly as displaced households likely have limited access to their livestock (Figure 10).

Assumptions

In addition to the national-level assumptions, the following assumptions apply to this area of concern:

- The high tension and risk of insecurity and conflict are likely to continue reducing access to markets and other livelihood activities throughout the scenario period. In particular, clashes during the harvest between November 2022 and January 2023 are likely to reduce labor opportunities, limiting household access to income and food from their own harvests.
- A localized below-average harvest is expected as many households were not able to plant and cultivate their farms due to insecurity and localized flooding this year. As a result, household food stocks are likely to remain below average throughout the scenario period, along with increased losses in the carry-over stock by conflict and attacks on villages.
- The rising cost of food and non-food items, limited access to income due to lower economic activity, and fewer income-earning opportunities are expected to continue limiting household purchasing power for agropastoral and daily wage-dependent households.

Most Likely Food Security Outcomes

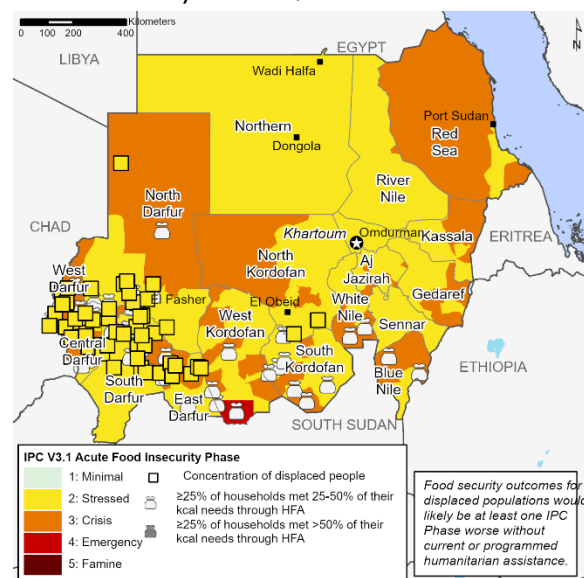
Between October 2022 and January 2023, the insecurity and high tension in the area is expected to limit poor households' access to their farms during the harvest period and to in-kind and cash payments from agricultural labor. Additionally, the high cost of food and lower-than-normal purchasing power will limit poor household ability to purchase foods from the market. Most of the displaced households are likely to rely on humanitarian assistance from non-governmental organizations, the government, and the community. Most displaced and conflict-affected households are expected to engage in consumption based coping strategies such as reducing the quantity and quality of meals, along with reducing household diet diversity. Accordingly, most poor households will likely continue to face food consumption gaps and be in Crisis (IPC Phase 3).

From February to May 2023, poor households in Ar Rusayries and Wad Al Mahi localities are likely to continue facing poor access to food as the post-harvest period shifts to the beginning of the lean season in April and May, as a result of the below average harvest and limited food stocks. Most IDP and conflict-affected households will likely increase their dependency on market purchases by March through May 2023, along with humanitarian assistance and communal support. Most of the IDPs and conflict-affected households' access to normal income sources and other livelihood options will continue to be limited by insecurity and social tensions in the area. The insecurity will also limit opportunities to seek wage labor opportunities in nearby towns and limit access to remittances from family members from outside the area. As a result of limited access to income for market purchases and low food stocks, households are likely to increasingly engage in coping strategies to mitigate food consumption gaps, particularly in the absence of humanitarian food assistance. As the lean season approaches, a growing number of households are expected to face Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes or worse due to limited access to income to purchase food from markets, and a lack of food stocks due to the conflict disrupting the 2022/2023 agricultural season.

MOST LIKELY FOOD SECURITY OUTCOMES AND AREAS RECEIVING SIGNIFICANT LEVELS OF HUMANITARIAN ASSISTANCE

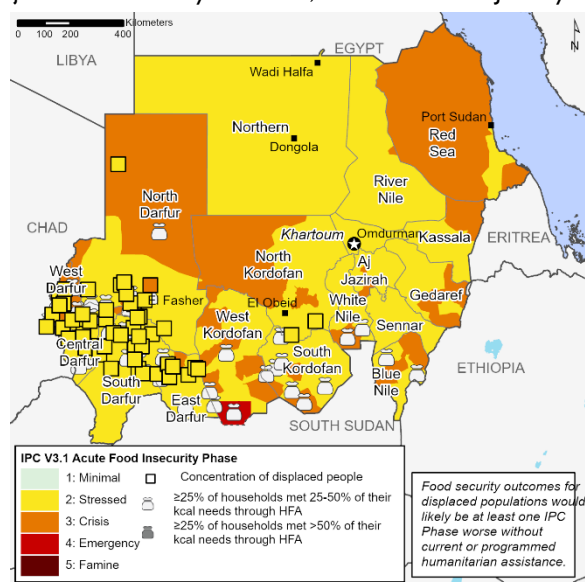
Each of these maps adheres to IPC v3.1 humanitarian assistance mapping protocols and flags where significant levels of humanitarian assistance are being/are expected to be provided. ☐ indicates that at least 25 percent of households receive on average 25–50 percent of caloric needs from humanitarian food assistance (HFA). ☐ indicates that at least 25 percent of households receive on average over 50 percent of caloric needs through HFA. This mapping protocol differs from the (!) protocol used in the maps at the top of the report. The use of (!) indicates areas that would likely be at least one phase worse in the absence of current or programmed humanitarian assistance.

Current food security outcomes, October 2022



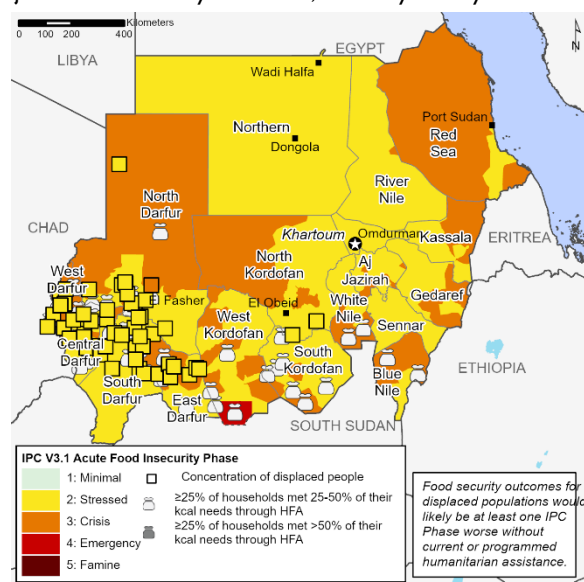
Source: FEWS NET

Projected food security outcomes, October 2022 to January 2023



Source: FEWS NET

Projected food security outcomes, February to May 2023



Source: FEWS NET

FEWS NET's classifications are IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners.

FEWS NET. Sudan Food Security Outlook October 2022 to May 2023: Conflict and poor macroeconomic conditions drive Crisis (IPC Phase 3) acute food insecurity; 2022.

ABOUT SCENARIO DEVELOPMENT

To project food security outcomes, FEWS NET develops a set of assumptions about likely events, their effects, and the probable responses of various actors. FEWS NET analyzes these assumptions in the context of current conditions and local livelihoods to arrive at a most likely scenario for the coming eight months. [Learn more here.](#)